

LESSON 9 | HANDLING DIFFICULT PEOPLE

Romans 12:18 (NLT): “Do all that you can to live in peace with everyone.”

A SHEPHERD HANDLES DIFFICULT PEOPLE BY:

1.

1 Thessalonians 5:14 (NLT): “We ask you, brothers and sisters, to warn those who are lazy, encourage those who are timid, take tender care of those who are weak, and be patient with everyone.”

2.

Ephesians 4:2 (NLT): “Always be humble and gentle. Be patient with each other, making allowance for each other’s faults because of your love.”

3. _____.

Romans 16:17 (NLT): “And now I make one more appeal, my dear brothers and sisters. Watch out for people who cause divisions and upset people’s faith by teaching things contrary to what you have been taught. Stay away from them.”

4. _____.

Ephesians 4:15 (NLT): “Instead, we will speak the truth in love, growing in every way more and more like Christ, who is the head of his body, the church.”

5. _____.

Galatians 6:1 (NLT): “Dear brothers and sisters, if another believer is overcome by some sin, you who are godly should gently and humbly help that person back onto the right path.”

Titus 3:10 (NLT): “If people are causing divisions among you, give a first and second warning. After that, have nothing more to do with them.”

PRACTICAL APPLICATION FOR PASTORS

Their behavior often reflects their own issues, not your leadership.

Keep notes on key meetings or conflicts.

Involve trusted leaders before making big decisions.

God can change hearts you never could.

Even if you must set boundaries or part ways, leave the door open for reconciliation.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1. What types of difficult people do you encounter most in ministry?**
- 2. How can you respond patiently without letting problems linger?**

3. When have you had to set boundaries, and how did it affect the church?
4. How do you balance truth and love when confronting someone?
5. When is it right to release someone from ministry involvement or membership?

ASSIGNMENT

- Identify **one difficult relationship** you are currently navigating in your ministry.
- Pray for that person daily this week.
- Take **one step** toward addressing the situation with patience, clarity, and love.